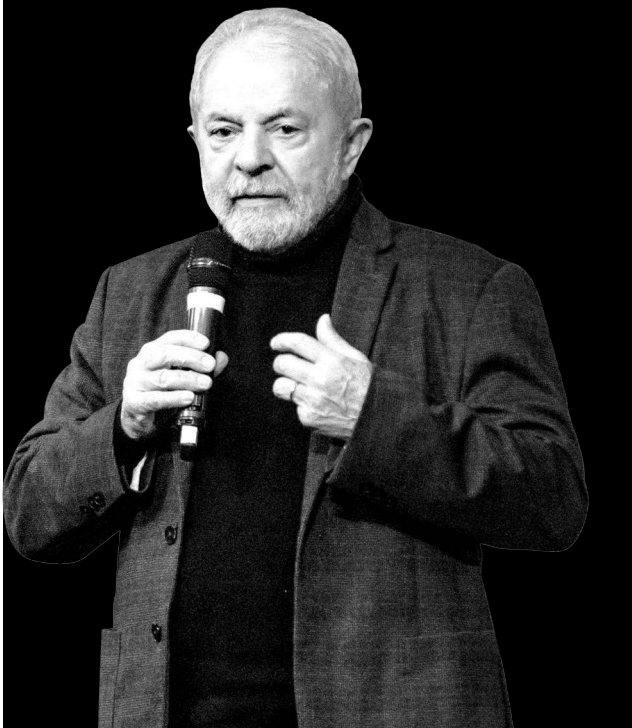


A Tough Act

After India's G20 presidency—that saw the Global South taking centre stage—all eyes are now on how Brazilian President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva takes it forward in 2024. Lula has outlined Brazil's agenda, including fighting extreme poverty and hunger, sustainable development, renewable energy, and reform of global governance institutions. What makes his task tougher are the two ongoing wars. How Lula manages to bring G20 members together will be interesting to watch.



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Tech to the Rescue

AI-based drug discovery is emerging as a transformative trend in India. Its potential to identify and develop affordable treatments for prevalent diseases like tuberculosis and malaria can significantly impact public health outcomes. AI is empowering local organisations to compete on a global scale by accelerating drug discovery within the country. This approach is not only expected to address affordability issues, but also create highly skilled jobs in the country in the coming years.

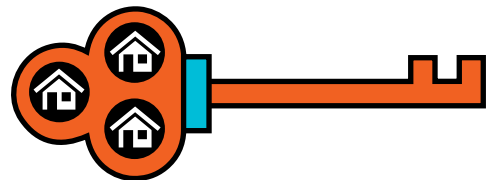


DELICATELY POISED

Y. K. HAMIED, Chairman of Cipla, enters 2024 under the spotlight. His company is grappling with uncertainty over a potential sale that has now stalled. While his family wants to reinvest profits into affordable healthcare, potential buyers want market expansion and shareholder returns. As 2024 unfolds, it holds the promise of being pivotal for both Hamied and Cipla.

PASSIVE AGGRESSION

IN 2024, PASSIVE investments are poised to play a more significant role in the market, with the rise of new-age MF companies like Zerodha Fund House focussing solely on it. Passive investments now account for almost 17 per cent of overall investments, up from a mere 1.4 per cent in 2015. Over half the U.S. market uses passive techniques, reflecting their global appeal.



Red Hot REITs

MARKETS REGULATOR SEBI and a large section of market participants are promoting Real Estate Investment Trusts (REITs) as a liquid alternative to physical real estate investments. Recently, Sebi even relaxed norms for small- and medium-sized REITs (SM REITs) to popularise REITs. The SM REIT space is expected to grow in 2024 as more players explore the new avenue for attracting retail investments into fractional ownership of properties with a minimum value of ₹50 crore, a huge drop from the ₹500 crore limit for normal REITs.